



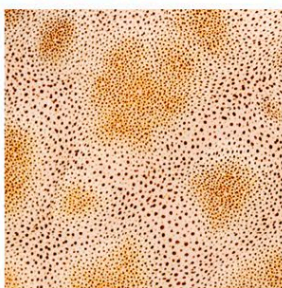
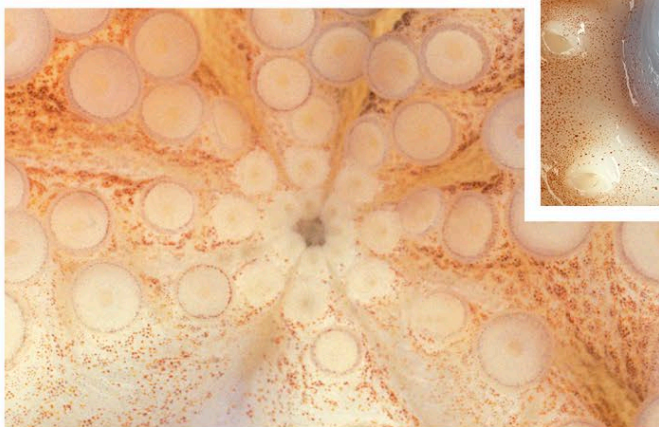
▽ UNDERSIDE

The octopus is a cephalopod, which literally means “head-footed”. Its eight mobile arms radiate from the underside of the head, where the mouth can be seen at the centre.



^ FUNNEL, OPEN AND CLOSED

On one side of the mantle, just behind the head, is a funnel, which the octopus uses in three ways: to expel water after gills have extracted oxygen; to rapidly discharge water as jet propulsion for a quick getaway; and to squirt a confusing cloud of ink at the enemy before fleeing.



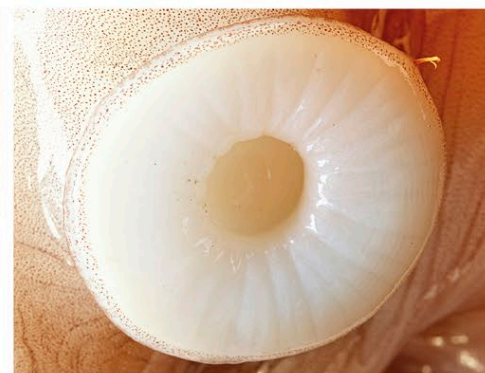
< SKIN

The skin contains special cells called chromatophores. These contain pigment which can change the octopus's colour – to blend in with its surroundings or to signal its mood if angry or afraid.



< BEAK

This octopus is a predator of crustaceans, among other prey. Its jaws are a parrot-like beak, which is strong enough to penetrate the tough carapace of a crab or lobster.



^ SUCKER

Each arm has two series of suckers. These give the octopus an excellent grip, allowing it to negotiate the sea bottom and coral reefs with ease. The suckers also have receptors that enable the octopus to taste what it is touching.



prominent eye
with a horizontal,
slit-shaped pupil

tough, warty skin can
change colour, texture, and
shape for camouflage

long, muscular arms for
moving over the seabed
and grasping objects

cup-like suckers